Post-mortem: order database failover, 14 March 2026

Summary: the Northwind order database primary became unreachable at 02:07 UTC. An automatic failover promoted a replica that had not yet replayed the last write-ahead log segments, so roughly nine minutes of order writes were lost from the read path until the segments were replayed.

Detection: the on-call engineer was paged after 11 minutes. The recovery time objective for the order database is 15 minutes, so the objective was met by a narrow margin.

Root cause and actions

Root cause: the failover controller promoted a replica without checking its replay lag against the 5 second limit.

Action PM-4471: block promotion of any replica whose replay lag exceeds 5 seconds. Owner: platform team. Due: 30 April.
Action PM-4472: page the on-call engineer after 3 minutes of primary unavailability instead of 10 minutes.